

A DOCUMENTARY BY PEDRO FERIA PINO / VEFILM

ALL IN

The Most American Addiction

40-55 min single doc / scales to 3-part limited series

01

C O L D O P E N

Andrew Douglas tried to kill himself over gambling debts.

He survived. When he woke up in the hospital, hooked to IVs, a nurse turned on the NBA Finals and handed him back his phone.

He opened FanDuel and gambled away his last hundred dollars from the bed.

This is the system working as designed.



America's \$150-billion-a-year sports betting boom has a body count. The companies feeding the bonfire, **FanDuel, DraftKings, Kalshi, the NFL itself**, are protected by a White House that owns a piece of the game and a Congress that just had to fine its own candidates for betting on themselves.

***ALL IN** is the story of the new American casino, the young men dying inside it, and the people getting rich off the bleeding.*

WHAT THIS FILM IS

Three Threads. One System.

I

THE ADDICTED

A generation of young men engineered into compulsive gambling. Highest suicide rate of any addiction. Half of all American men 18-49 have an active sports betting account.

II

THE APPS

FanDuel, DraftKings, Kalshi, Polymarket. Built on data from the leagues themselves. VIP hosts, micro-betting loops, AI-targeted promotions. Dopamine machines disguised as fun.

III

THE FIX

Trump Jr. advises Kalshi and invests in Polymarket. The NFL owns a chunk of the data company powering the bets. Congress had to ban itself from the platforms. The casino is the state now.

THE SCALE

\$1 TRILLION

in cumulative American sports betting losses by 2028.

\$5B → \$150B

Annual US sports bets, 2018 vs. last year.

1 in 5

Problem gamblers attempt suicide. Highest of any addiction.

~50%

Of US men 18-49 have an active sports betting account.

The Body Count

FRANKIE, late 20s

"I got married last May. The guests gave us a pillowcase full of cash. I lost it all on FanDuel. Defaulted on the mortgage. Suicide was my only option till I found Harry."

ANDREW, ex-baseball player

"In the hospital, after my suicide attempt, they turned the NBA Finals on and gave me my phone. I gambled away my last \$100."

MARCUS, college gamer

"When I owed money to every kid I knew and was betting on Chinese ping-pong at 4 a.m., I tried going for counseling on campus. As I'm talking to the counselor, she's pulling a manual off the shelf, looking up problem gambling."



Engineered to Maximize Addiction

CASE STUDY / THE THOMPSON FILE

\$22 MILLION WAGERED.
\$1.8 MILLION LOST.

When Thompson tried to slow down, his FanDuel VIP host called him with an "emergency": free Super Bowl tickets, hotel, party passes. He had just decided to kill himself. He's now a named plaintiff in a March 2026 lawsuit alleging the apps are "unreasonably dangerous products intentionally designed to maximize addiction."

M I C R O - B E T S

Wagers on individual pitches, plays, possessions.
Slot-machine rhythm at sporting events.

V I P H O S T S

Personal handlers calling heavy losers with comps
and Super Bowl tickets to keep them in.

A I T A R G E T I N G

Push notifications and free-spin offers timed to each
user's behavior. The book sees you.

The Casino Is the State Now

WHITE HOUSE

Donald Trump Jr. is a paid advisor to Kalshi and an investor in Polymarket, the two largest prediction markets in the country, where users bet on elections, wars, and assassinations. Trump Media launched its own platform, Truth Predict, in 2025.

CONGRESS

April 2026: the Senate unanimously banned its own members from trading on prediction markets, after Kalshi caught three congressional candidates betting on their own races. House version is in motion.

THE LEAGUES

The NFL is the largest shareholder in Genius Sports, the data company powering the microbets. MLB, NBA, NHL all sold their data to FanDuel and DraftKings. The leagues are partners with the books.

THE MILITARY

April 2026: a Special Forces master sergeant was arrested for allegedly using classified intel about the mission to capture Venezuelan President Maduro to win \$410,000 on Polymarket. First insider-trading prosecution involving a prediction market.

W H Y N O W

This Story Breaks Open This Month.

M A Y 2 0 , 2 0 2 6

FIRST CONGRESSIONAL HEARING

Senate Commerce Subcommittee holds its first formal hearing on sports betting and prediction markets.

M A Y 2 9 , 2 0 2 6

MARKETING DATA DUE

Ten companies (DraftKings, FanDuel, Kalshi, Polymarket, BetMGM, Caesars, Fanatics, PrizePicks, Robinhood, bet365) must turn over youth-marketing data to Congress.

M A R C H 2 0 2 6

LANDMARK LAWSUIT

Public Health Advocacy Institute files suit against FanDuel, DraftKings, the NFL, and Genius Sports, alleging the apps are "unreasonably dangerous products."

O N G O I N G

CLASS ACTIONS

Nationwide suits piling up on behalf of young adults and families who lost loved ones to gambling-related suicide.

Who We Talk To

THE SURVIVORS

Andrew Douglas (on the record with Rolling Stone, CBS). Frankie and Marcus (Harry Levant's treatment groups). Thompson (named plaintiff, Philly lawsuit).

OUR ANCHOR

Harry Levant. Disbarred lawyer, recovered gambler, now the leading public-health voice in the country on gambling addiction. Forty weeks a year on the road testifying to legislators.

THE FIGHT

Sen. Chris Murphy (BETS OFF Act). Sen. Richard Blumenthal. Public Health Advocacy Institute. Rep. Paul Tonko. Parents from UK Parliament Young Adults Reports.

THE DEFECTORS

Former VIP hosts and account managers from FanDuel and DraftKings, named in active lawsuit filings. These are the people who made the late-night phone calls.

The Phone Is the Antagonist.



We shoot it like one. Blue screen-glow on faces in dark rooms. Vertical compositions inside the apps, designed to feel like the slot-machine dopamine loop they actually are. Anamorphic, Kodachrome-leaning palette for the world outside the addiction. Verite in the recovery rooms.

Single Doc First. Series If You Want It.

THE FILM

40-55 min Single Doc

Built for FRONTLINE, VICE News Presents, Op-Docs, HBO/Showtime singles, CNN Films, Netflix one-offs. Three threads woven together. The hospital-bed scene as cold open. Levant as anchor. Thompson lawsuit and Senate hearing as spine.

SCALES TO

3-Part Limited Series

- EP 1 THE ADDICTED. Character-driven. Survivors, families, recovery rooms.
- EP 2 THE APPS. The lawsuit, the VIP hosts, the engineering of addiction.
- EP 3 THE FIX. Trump family, Congress, the leagues, prediction markets.



F I L M M A K E R

Pedro Feria Pino

Director / Director of Photography

Brooklyn-based Director of Photography and SOC Camera Operator. 20+ years across unscripted television, documentary, and narrative film. Founder of VEFILM.

S E L E C T E D C R E D I T S

Netflix / Disney / VICE / MTV / VH1 / ABC News / Hearst

Co-Creator / Camera Op / Producer, *Washington Heights* (MTV)

Supervising Producer, *Love & Hip Hop* franchise

LET'S BUILD IT.

The Senate hearing is May 20. The marketing data drops May 29. The lawsuit goes through discovery this summer. The window to be the first film on this is now.

PEDRO FERIA PINO / VEFILM

vefilm@gmail.com / pedroferiapino.com